



A Descriptive Study on Patients' Satisfaction Regarding Nursing Care at Tertiary Cancer Center

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ABSTRACT

Background: Nursing care is major component of health care services where patients are expected to receive quality care from nurses. Patient satisfaction is perception of care received in meeting various health needs that help to achieve optimum level of health and wellness. Furthermore, patient satisfaction is considered a vital component in determining healthcare quality. This study was conducted to assess the level of patients' satisfaction regarding nursing care.

Method: A descriptive cross sectional research design was used with nonprobability purposive sampling technique among 100 admitted patients. Data was obtained using structured interview schedule. Level of patients' satisfaction was assessed in relation to four major aspects of nursing care. Ethical approval was received from BPKMCH institutional review board. All collected data were analyzed and interpreted by using descriptive statistics and inferential statistics including chi-square.

Results: The study findings revealed that less than half (36%) respondents were of age group 36-50 and (55%) were male. The result further shows (64%) respondents were satisfied with communication skills of nurses while more than half (58%) were satisfied with technical skills of nurses. Regarding attitude of nurses, only (39%) were satisfied while (46%) were satisfied with cleanliness of ward environment. Additionally, (58%) respondents were satisfied with overall nursing care. Only ethnicity (0.017) was statistically significant with level of satisfaction at $p < 0.05$.

Conclusion: In conclusion, overall patient satisfaction was quite similar among four aspects of nursing care however dissatisfaction with attitude of nurses. So, to improve attitude and other aspects of nursing care, positive reinforcement, collaborative learning and constructive feedback is essential. Furthermore, setting clear consequences is also recommended.

Keywords: Nursing care; Patients; Satisfaction; Skills.

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INTRODUCTION

Nurses, backbone of health care sectors, play major role in delivering primary health care services to the patient in the hospital where patient satisfaction is identified as major indicator for evaluating service quality [1]. Patient satisfaction is where the expectations of the patient meet with the reality of health care services and nurses have major role in it. The expected health needs are related to nursing care, interpersonal interaction, delivery and result of care, communication with the patients, meeting the patient's needs, patient's physical environment and so on [2]. As nurses are the primary contact for patients throughout their hospital stay, nursing services such as responsiveness, communication, empathy, technical competence, and the ability to provide comfort directly influence patient perceptions, clinical outcomes and hospital reputation and overall satisfaction [3]. Likewise, American Nurses Association defines 'patient satisfaction with nursing care' as patients' opinion of care received from nursing staff during their hospitalization [4]. When the patients are satisfied, they take active role in self-care leading to high treatment compliance which in turn helps health professionals in improving the services and decreasing the health expenditure [2]. Many times, patients assess the overall quality of hospital ser-

vices based on their interactions with nursing staff, making nursing care a major factor of patient satisfaction [1]. Thus, measuring patient satisfaction is a vital source of information for identifying gaps and developing an effective action plan for quality improvement in healthcare organizations [5]. Research conducted in Tehran revealed that 82.8% of the respondents were satisfied with the care provided to them while 17.2% were dissatisfied [6].

METHODS

A descriptive cross-sectional study design was carried out to assess Patients' Satisfaction regarding Nursing Care at Tertiary Cancer Center. The study was carried out among 100 patients admitted in different wards of BPKMCH by using non-probability purposive sampling technique [7]. Patients who were admitted over 48 hours were only taken as samples. The structured interview schedule was developed and consisted of two parts as socio-demographic related questionnaire and questions related to patients' satisfaction regarding nursing care respectively. Patient satisfaction was scored by using a 5-point Likert Scale which indicates degree of satisfaction or dissatisfaction where it was classified and scored as very unsatisfied-1, unsatisfied-2, neutral-3, satisfied-4, very satisfied-5. Level of satisfaction was measured

by calculating the total score and then mean was calculated. Score higher than mean was considered as satisfied while and lower than mean was considered as dissatisfied [8, 9]. Validity of the instrument was maintained by extensive literature review, consultation with oncologist and research expert. Before collecting the data, ethical approval for the study was obtained from the Institutional Review Committee of BP Koirala Memorial Cancer Hospital. (Ref. No. 88/081/082) and the objectives of the study were explained and written informed consent was obtained from each respondent before data collection and ensured the confidentiality. The interview was for 20 to 30 minutes. All collected data were entered and analyzed by Statistical Package for Social Science (SPSS) version 22. Data was interpreted by using descriptive and inferential statistics in terms of mean, frequency and percentage and displayed in different tables.

RESULTS

Socio- demographic characteristics of 100 respondents show half of the respondents (50%) were of age group above 51 years. The mean age of respondents was 50.60 and standard deviation was 13.77 with minimum age 20 and maximum age 85. And regarding the gender, more than half (55%) were male whereas remaining were female. In case of ethnicity, (40%) were Brahmin/Chhetri and maximum (86%) follow Hindu religion. Regarding educational status, only (49%) of respondents had primary level of education whereas nearly half (49%) were involved in agriculture. Likewise, majority (86%) were married. In relation to address, one third (33%) of the respondents were from Lumbini province.

Table 1. Level of Respondents' Satisfaction in Relation to Different Variables ($n = 100$)

Variables	Mean	Satisfied (%)	Dissatisfied (%)
Communication skill	35.75	64 (64.0)	36 (36.0)
Technical skills	32.69	58 (58.0)	42 (42.0)
Attitude of nurse	29.36	39 (39.0)	61 (61.0)
Cleanliness of ward environment	18.18	46 (46.0)	54 (54.0)

Table 1 shows (64%) were satisfied whereas (36%) respondents were dissatisfied with communication skills of nurses. Similarly, more than half (58%) of respondents were satisfied while (42%) were dissatisfied with the technical skill of nurses. Whereas (61%) were dissatisfied but only (39%) were satisfied with regards to attitude of nurses. Likewise, more than half (54%) were dissatisfied with cleanliness of ward environment while (46%) were satisfied.

Figure 1 shows more than half (58%) respondents were satisfied whereas 42% were dissatisfied regarding nursing care based on the calculated mean value.

Level of satisfaction

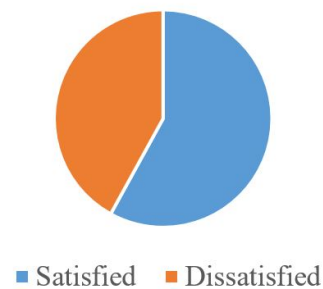


Figure 1. Respondents' Satisfaction Level regarding Nursing Care ($n=100$)

Table 2. Association between Level of Satisfaction and Demographic Variables ($n = 100$)

Variables	Level of satisfaction		Chi-square	P-value
	Satisfied	Dissatisfied		
Age				
20–35	7 (50.0%)	7 (50.0%)	2.168	0.705
36–50	23 (63.9%)	13 (36.1%)		
≥51	28 (69.7%)	22 (30.3%)		
Sex				
Male	30 (54.5%)	25 (45.5%)	0.599	0.439
Female	28 (62.2%)	17 (37.8%)		
Ethnicity				
Brahmin/ Chettri	26 (65.0%)	14 (35.0%)	12.068	0.017*
Dalit	5 (62.5%)	3 (37.5%)		
Janajati	14 (38.9%)	22 (61.1%)		
Madhesi	9 (75.0%)	3 (25.0%)		
Muslim	4 (100.0%)	0 (0.0%)		
Religion				
Hindu	49 (57.0%)	37 (43.0%)	6.152	0.104
Buddhist	5 (55.6%)	4 (44.4%)		
Muslim	4 (100.0%)	0 (0.0%)		
Christian	0 (0.0%)	1 (100.0%)		

Note: *Significant at the 0.05 level.

Table 2 denotes the association between the level of respondents' satisfaction with selected demographic variables. The result shows that demographic variables such as Age, gender, religion are not statistically significant while ethnicity (0.017) is significant at p-value 0.05.

Table 3 denotes above demographic variables as educational status, occupation, marital status and area of resident are not statistically significant as the p-value 0.05.

DISCUSSION

In this study, (36%) of respondents were of age group 36-50. The similar study conducted in Nepal in 2019 shows majority (34.7%) were of age group 18-33 [10]. In this study, more than half (55%) were male while remaining were female. Nearly half (40%) of respondents were Brahmin/Chhetri which is supported by study conducted in Nepal in 2023 shows (21.05%) were Brahmin/Chhetri [11]. Regarding religion, (86%) were Hindu. Similar result with the study conducted in Nepal in 2019 have ma-

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jority (89.3%) Hindu.8 Similarly, maximum (86%) were married, (49%) of respondents had primary level of education and one third were from Lumbini province. As for occupation, nearly half (49%) were involved in agriculture. In present study, more than half (64%) were satisfied whereas (36%) were dissatisfied with communication skills of nurses. Similar study conducted in Nepal in 2023 identified (55%) fully satisfied with nurses communication with patient and families [11]. More than half (58%) of respondents were satisfied while (42%) were dissatisfied with the technical skill of nurses which is supported by the study conducted in Iran in 2010 shows maximum (76.6%) were satisfied with information given by nurses while (23.4%) were not satisfied [6]. Likewise, (76.8%) were satisfied with technical quality of nurses but (23.2%) were not satisfied with it. Regarding attitude of nurses, maximum (61%) were dissatisfied while only (39%) were satisfied. Similarly, more than half (54%) were dissatisfied with cleanliness of ward environment while (46%) were satisfied which is supported by the study conducted in Iran in 2010 shows majority (69.5%) were satisfied with physical environment while (30.5%) were not satisfied.6 Regarding overall satisfaction level of respondents' regarding nursing care, more than half (58%) were satisfied whereas (42%) were dissatisfied which is supported by the study conducted in Nepal in 2019 shows that maximum (94.3%) was satisfied with nursing care whereas (5.7%) were dissatisfied [10], whereas a study conducted in Nepal in 2019 showed that 49% had good satisfaction whereas 51% had poor regarding quality of nursing care.8 Given research show demographic variables such as Age, gender, religion, educational status, occupation, marital status and area of resident are not statistically significant while ethnicity (0.017) is significant at p-value 0.05.

CONCLUSIONS

Based on the finding, it is concluded that more than half of the patients were satisfied with nursing care at tertiary level hospital. The patient satisfaction level is quite similar among the various nursing care aspects that include communication skills of nurses, technical skills and cleanliness of ward environment. However, dissatisfaction was observed regarding attitude of nurses. Overall, majority of patients expressed satisfaction with the nursing care provided. Thus, regularly assessing nursing care standards and implementing improvement strategies based on patient feedback and providing constructive guidance helps in interpersonal aspects of care.

Conflict of Interest: None

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